A Waltz Of Daggers

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A Waltz Of Daggers

by Lunaeryi

Summary

Phainon is a top-tier assassin—silent, precise, unstoppable. Or at least, he was until Mydei, his target who he accidentally saved.

Somehow, every time he is finally mentally prepared to get rid of him, Mydei wanders too close, flashes a smile, or—worst of all—starts a conversation. Phainon should be annoyed. Instead, he's distracted. And maybe, just maybe, a little smitten.

Notes

IM ALIVE!!!!! Sorry for the late post y'all, I've been busy with life😭

This time we're doing Assassins AU, recommended by a dear reader <333 (It's a bit rushed tho sorry)

I hope u guys enjoy!!!

See the end of the work for more notes

The streets of the capital pulsed with restless energy, the glow of lanterns casting fractured light against damp stone. Murmurs wove through the air, slipping between alleyways like whispered confessions—trade deals spoken in hushed tones, secrets bartered in the dark, knives finding ribs where no one would see.

The city was alive, as it always was after nightfall.

Phainon moved like a ghost through the labyrinth of backstreets, unseen, unheard. Tonight was not a night for blood. It was a night for watching.

The contract was fresh, its details scarce. A prince to kill. A crown to destabilize. The usual.

His orders were simple: learn the layout of the palace, track the prince's routine, find the chinks in his armor. This was a job that required patience, the kind of work best done slipping between the cracks, unnoticed.

Then fate played its first trick.

A disturbance broke the rhythm of the streets—a quiet struggle, just subtle enough to be missed by an untrained ear. Phainon's steps faltered for half a breath before instinct carried him into the shadows, tracking the sound down a narrow side street.

There, in the dim alley, two men loomed over a third, their blades catching the flicker of lanternlight. Not common thieves. Their stances were too measured, their movements too precise. Mercenaries, then—hired for something more than coin.

The young man they had cornered was unarmed, his back pressed against the stone wall. His cloak, though dark, was finely woven—a noble's.

Not Phainon's problem.

He should have walked away. The job came first. Always.

But something about the scene felt off. A prickle at the base of his spine, the kind of warning that had kept him alive all these years. This wasn't a simple mugging.

His hand moved before his mind caught up.

A blade sliced through the air, meeting its mark in the throat of the first attacker. The man choked, staggered, then crumpled. The second barely had time to turn before Phainon was upon him. A twist of the wrist, a flick of steel—an exhale, and it was over.

Silence.

The young man had barely moved, his only betrayal a sharp inhale. His hood had slipped in the struggle, revealing pale hair and striking golden eyes. He wasn't afraid. Just watching. His gaze flicked between Phainon's dagger and the bodies cooling at his feet, assessing rather than recoiling.

"You're welcome," Phainon muttered, retrieving his knife.

Still, the stranger didn't run. Instead, he exhaled, straightened, and smoothed the folds of his cloak, as if shedding the moment like dust from his sleeves. "That was efficient." A pause. His gaze lifted, steady now. "You didn't have to help me."

Phainon tilted his head, studying him in return. "Didn't have to," he admitted. "Didn't want to see you gutted in an alley either."

The young man huffed—something between amusement and disbelief. "Practical reasoning."

Phainon shrugged, already turning away when the stranger spoke again.

"Then I owe you."

Phainon hesitated, just for a fraction of a second, before shaking his head. "I don't take debts."

Another beat of silence. Then, a shift—subtle, but weighted. The stranger extended a gloved hand. “Still. Mydei.”

A name. Just that. And yet Phainon felt it settle in his mind like a puzzle piece snapping into place.

He didn’t take the offered hand. Instead, he met Mydei’s gaze and said, “Just call me Snowy.” It wasn’t a lie, but it wasn’t the truth either. Tribbie had given him that name long ago, and right now, it felt safer than his real one.

Mydei studied him, eyes sharp as if committing every detail to memory. Then, instead of insisting, he let his hand drop to his side with a small nod.

The moment should have ended there.

But as Phainon stepped back into the shadows, he felt Mydei’s gaze lingering on his back—not afraid, not grateful. Just… curious.

And for some reason, Phainon found himself wondering if this was truly the last time their paths would cross.

Something told him it wasn’t.

Not by a long shot.

Later that night, Mydei stood in his chambers, candlelight casting long, flickering shadows along the walls. In his palm rested a small, curved blade —no longer than a finger—lightweight, razor-sharp, and unmistakably well-crafted.

Not a standard throwing knife. Too personal.

He turned it between his fingers, feeling the smooth, cool metal, the balance of its weight. It was made for precision, honed for swift, silent kills. A weapon like this wasn’t something one discarded lightly.

He’d seen the stranger retrieve his knives after the fight, quick and meticulous, leaving nothing behind. And yet, this one had remained.

Deliberate? Unlikely. A mistake? Perhaps.

But something about that man told Mydei he was not the type to make careless mistakes.

His thoughts drifted back to the alleyway—the flash of movement, the clean, effortless brutality of the kills. The stranger had cut through his attackers with a grace that was almost unnatural, each strike controlled, measured, purposeful. Deadly, but not ruthless. There had been no hesitation in his movements, but neither had there been excess.

Like this blade.

Sharp, elegant, efficient—dangerous, yet beautiful.

Just like its owner.

The memory of him lingered, unshakable. A man wrapped in shadows and moonlight, his presence as fleeting as it was unforgettable. There was something unsettling about him, something Mydei couldn’t quite define. He had been a ghost, moving without sound, striking without effort. But there had also been a strange ease in him, an unbothered calm even as he left two corpses cooling on the street.

A man like that was no mere sellsword.

And yet, despite everything, despite the unmistakable danger thrumming beneath his skin, Mydei had found his gaze lingering. The stranger had been lethal, yes—but he had also been beautiful. Not in the way noble courtiers were, with their polished smiles and carefully arranged elegance, but in a way that was raw and untamed. The way a blade was beautiful in the moment before it struck.

He turned the knife over again, tracing the edge with the pad of his thumb. A weapon, sleek and perfect in its design. Made for one purpose, yet in his

hands now.

He wasn’t sure what to make of that.

Exhaling, Mydei let the name slip from his lips, barely more than a murmur.

“Snowy, is it?”

The quiet of his chambers swallowed the words, but the name lingered in the air, settling like an unanswered question. He closed his fingers around the blade, feeling the metal bite, cold and sharp, against his palm.

A strange thing, to hold a piece of someone like that.

He had a feeling he would see him again.

And next time, he intended to learn exactly what kind of man carried a blade like this.

Phainon sat in the corner of a quiet tavern, idly tracing the rim of his cup as he waited. The air was thick with the scent of ale and damp wood, conversation ebbing and flowing around him like a tide he had no interest in.

The contract had been confirmed: a prince. That was all he had been told thus far. A royal kill—nothing he hadn’t done before. It would demand time, patience, and precision, as always.

However, the identity of his target remained unknown.

For now.

A quiet shift of air. A presence settling across from him.

Aglaea had arrived.

She moved with a measured grace, her composure untouched by the noise of the room. Dressed in deep blues and silvers, she looked as though she

belonged to a realm far grander than this dingy establishment, yet she carried herself with the confidence of someone who knew the filth of the city could never truly touch her.

Phainon arched a brow. “That was quick.”

Aglaea merely inclined her head, lips curving into a hint of amusement. “The matter has been settled. The contract is in place.”

She slid a folded parchment across the table. He broke the seal without ceremony, scanning the name inside.

Crown Prince Mydeimos of Kremnos.

Phainon exhaled slowly, pressing his tongue against the back of his teeth.

Killing a crown prince. That would be a formidable task. Not impossible, but certainly difficult. A job like this required meticulous planning, patience, and a thorough understanding of the palace’s inner workings.

A challenge.

He could handle it.

Setting the parchment down, he tapped a finger against the name. “Crown Prince, huh?” His tone remained even, unbothered. “Tch. That’ll be a mess.”

A soft hum escaped Aglaea. “I trust you are not daunted.”

“Not particularly.” He took a slow sip of his drink, mulling it over. The palace was heavily fortified. A place like Castrum Kremnos was a fortress in itself. He’d need to plan meticulously—

Wait.

Phainon stilled, something tugging at the edges of his thoughts, like a puzzle piece snapping into place.

Mydeimos.

Mydei.

My-deimos.

Oh.

Oh.

He shut his eyes for half a second, then tilted his head back against the chair, staring at the ceiling in utter disbelief.

Aglaea's gaze sharpened, concern creeping into her features. "Something the matter?"

He let out a slow, steady breath through his nose. "Not really." A pause. Then, under his breath—"I just really, really fucked up."

Aglaea studied him, her expression betraying nothing, but Phainon could tell she was watching him carefully.

He exhaled through his nose, running a hand through his hair before sitting up properly. "Alright," he muttered, raking his fingers over the parchment once more. "Crown Prince Mydeimos. He's the target."

Aglaea's lips quirked, just slightly. "That is what the contract states."

Phainon rolled his jaw, gaze flicking to the side as if the stained walls of the tavern might offer some clarity.

It wasn't like he hadn't killed nobility before. Royals, officials, generals—if the coin was good and the reasoning sound, it didn't matter who was on the receiving end of his blade. And it wasn't like five minutes in a dark alley meant anything. He'd saved plenty of people in passing, only to watch them die later, by his hand or someone else's.

So why did this feel…

Off.

Not wrong. Not enough to make him walk away. Just strange.

He traced a finger along the edge of the parchment, mind working through the logistics even as something in his gut twisted—not with guilt, not with doubt, but with an awareness he couldn't quite shake.

He didn't owe Mydei anything.

And yet.

Phainon huffed through his nose and leaned back in his chair. "Fine. I'll take the job."

Aglaea gave a small nod, as if she had never expected otherwise. "Then let us discuss the details."

He shifted forward again, drumming his fingers lightly against the tabletop. "Security?"

"Formidable, as you would expect," Aglaea replied smoothly. "The palace is heavily guarded, both inside and out. The Crown Prince rarely leaves its walls unattended, and when he does, he is accompanied by an elite retinue."

Phainon hummed, considering. "Poison?"

"Difficult, but not impossible. He does not partake in food or drink that has not been tasted first."

"Blade work, then." He tilted his head slightly, thinking it through. "A direct kill would be a nightmare. Too many guards, too much attention. I'd need to slip in unseen, catch him alone."

Aglaea inclined her head. "The upcoming ball may provide such an opportunity. I can secure an invitation, and amidst the revelry, it would be easier to move unnoticed."

Phainon exhaled slowly. A ball.

He wasn’t unfamiliar with disguises. And if Mydei—no, Mydeimos—was playing host, then he would be more vulnerable than usual.

“I can work with that.”

Aglaea’s lips curved slightly, approving. “I assumed as much.”

Phainon didn’t respond immediately, rolling his shoulders as he leaned back again.

It was a simple job. Not easy, but simple. He just had to do what he did best.

And yet, his mind drifted back to golden eyes watching him through the dim glow of lanternlight.

A meeting that should’ve meant nothing.

A name spoken in passing.

He had saved Mydei’s life.

And now, he was going to take it.

Well. That was how things went, wasn’t it?

Phainon exhaled sharply, shaking off the thought. It didn’t matter.

He had a job to do.

After the chaos of the day faded into twilight, Phainon found himself wandering through the winding streets of Kremnos, still familiarizing himself with the city’s pulse. The air was rich with the scent of roasting meat from nearby stalls and the laughter of merchants closing up for the night. He had spent most of his time gathering information about his new surroundings—eavesdropping on conversations and observing the city’s elite, all while trying to blend in with the crowd.

But as the stars began to flicker overhead, he needed a moment of quiet. He sought out a place that offered a reprieve from the noise and chaos. After some searching, he discovered a small, secluded park tucked away from the main thoroughfares. It was a pocket of tranquility, where the rustling leaves and distant sounds of the city felt muted. Phainon leaned against a weathered tree, closing his eyes and inhaling deeply, letting the calm wash over him.

But serenity was short-lived.

As he stood there, lost in thought, he sensed a shift in the air—a presence that felt too close. Before he could react, a figure emerged from the shadows, moving with startling speed. In an instant, Phainon found a blade pressed against his throat.

Surprised, he tensed, instinctively preparing to defend himself. But as his gaze fell on the familiar weapon—a single, curved blade—it struck him like a bolt of lightning. It was his own knife, the one he had left behind in the alley after saving the prince.

“Ah, it’s you,” came a voice, smooth and steady.

Phainon’s heart raced as he looked into the golden eyes of Mydei, the Crown Prince of Kremnos, his expression serious yet composed.

“Nice to see you, Snowy,” Mydei said, his tone carrying an unsettling confidence.

Phainon arched an eyebrow, surprised not only by the prince’s audacity but by the thrill it sent through him. “You have a unique way of saying hello, Your Highness.”

Mydei languidly settled himself on the grass beside Phainon, his posture relaxed but alert. “So you know.”

Phainon glanced at the knife still hovering near his throat, then back to Mydei. “Can I get my blade back?”

Mydei raised an eyebrow, the corner of his mouth quirking up. “Only if you tell me your real name.”

The demand caught Phainon off guard, silencing him momentarily. He weighed the implications, knowing full well that revealing too much could be detrimental. Mydei didn’t know he was marked for assassination, and the less he learned about Phainon, the better.

“Nice try,” Phainon finally replied, maintaining his composure as he retrieved the blade from Mydei’s hold. “But I think I’ll keep my secrets.”

Mydei smirked, unfazed. “Suit yourself. I’m keeping the blade.”

Phainon met Mydei’s gaze, sensing a challenge in those golden eyes. “So, this is how you spend your evenings? Threatening innocent strangers in dark corners?”

“Hardly innocent,” Mydei shot back, a glint of amusement flickering across his features. “You certainly know your way around a fight. But then again, I wouldn’t expect anything less from someone who can catch a blade that quickly.”

Phainon couldn’t help but feel a thrill at the exchange. “You’re more than you seem, Your Highness. I’ll give you that.”

Mydei met his gaze with a steady intensity, speaking indifferently. “And you’re a curious one, aren’t you? I’d advise you to tread carefully. Kremnos has eyes everywhere.”

“Trust me, I’m well aware,” Phainon replied, the tension between them palpable. “Just remember, not everyone you meet here is an ally.”

Mydei leaned in slightly, his expression curious yet serious. “And not everyone you meet is a threat. Just keep your blade close, Snowy.”

With that, the moment solidified, and an unspoken understanding hung in the air between them. Phainon chuckled lightly, shaking his head. “Well, I suppose I’ll just have to keep an eye out for you, Your Highness.”

Mydei paused, tilting his head slightly. “I wouldn’t have it any other way. Just try not to get yourself killed.”

“Right back at you, Mydei.” Phainon grinned, feeling a strange sense of camaraderie. They may have started as strangers, but this unexpected connection was something he hadn’t anticipated—and somehow, he found himself looking forward to what came next.

The palace gardens were quieter than the rest of Castrum Kremnos, tucked away from the rigid halls and the constant vigilance of the city. Phainon hadn’t come here with a purpose—just a moment to think, to breathe. He hadn’t expected to find Mydei already there.

The prince stood among the rows of flora, bathed in moonlight, his expression unreadable. The flickering torchlight of the palace barely reached this far, leaving only the silver glow of the stars and the faint scent of flowers.

Phainon lingered in the shadows, observing. Mydei was standing before a patch of asphodel, pale and ghostly under the night sky.

Phainon tilted his head. “Didn’t take you for the sentimental type, Your Highness.”

Mydei glanced at him but didn’t seem surprised. “Should I be?”

Phainon stepped forward, his gaze flicking to the flowers. “Asphodel. The Greeks thought it covered the fields of the dead. A flower of mourning. Memory.” He cast Mydei a sidelong glance. “Not exactly a cheerful choice.”

The prince studied the petals as if seeing them for the first time. “I just thought they looked… resilient.”

Phainon huffed a quiet laugh. “You’d like that.”

They walked in silence for a few steps, the night air cool against their skin. Mydei's gaze flickered across the garden, but there was no reverence in his eyes, no poetic musings—just quiet contemplation.

They passed a cluster of red camellias next, the petals lush and rich with color. Mydei looked to him expectantly.

Phainon exhaled. "Unwavering passion. Devotion." He smirked. "Not sure if that suits you."

Mydei's lips barely curved. "No?"

"No," Phainon said, amused. "You strike me as more of a nightshade type."

"Poisonous?"

"Dangerous."

Mydei hummed, unbothered. He slowed, his fingertips brushing against the leaves of another plant as he passed—aconite. Wolfsbane.

Phainon's posture tensed for half a second, but he said nothing. He knew what that plant could do. A mere touch wouldn't kill, but it would leave a burn, a numbness that spread like fire under the skin.

Mydei withdrew his hand without a single flinch, turning his gaze forward as if nothing had happened. He looked perfectly fine.

Phainon watched him walk ahead, his expression unreadable.

Then, quietly to himself, he murmured, "Huh. How curious."

Steam curled through the air, thick with the scent of clean stone and heated water. The bathhouse wasn't extravagant, not by royal standards, but it was well-kept—large enough for patrons to spread out, the low murmur of conversation blending with the occasional ripple of water.

Phainon hadn’t come here expecting company. He’d come because it was one of the few places in Kremnos where he could disappear, where no one looked too closely or asked too many questions.

And yet, as he settled into the water, the sound of approaching footsteps made him tense.

He recognized the figure even before he spoke.

“My, my. A familiar face.”

Phainon glanced up. Mydei stood at the edge of the water, his damp hair slightly tousled, his usual layers of finery stripped down to something simple—something that made him look less like a prince and more like any other man seeking a moment of peace.

Phainon exhaled, tipping his head back against the stone. “Should’ve known you’d be here, Your Highness.”

Mydei stepped in, sinking into the water with a slow ease, eyes half-lidded as the warmth settled into his muscles. “And yet, you look surprised.”

Phainon was. He hadn’t thought of Mydei as the type to frequent public spaces like this. Something about him—the rigid poise, the way he carried himself like a man always on guard—made it seem unlikely.

As if reading his thoughts, Mydei sighed. “For once, I have no obligations breathing down my neck. I figured I’d take advantage of that before someone finds a way to ruin it.” He sank deeper, resting his arms against the stone. “Though I suppose I’ve already been found.”

Phainon scoffed. “If it’s any consolation, I wasn’t looking for you.”

Mydei’s gaze flicked to him, something unreadable in his expression. Then, casually, he murmured, “You do have a habit of appearing when I least expect it.”

Phainon stilled.

It wasn’t a flirtation. It wasn’t a threat. It wasn’t even an accusation. Just an observation, spoken so smoothly, so carelessly, that it landed somewhere between an offhand remark and something far sharper.

For a fraction of a second, Phainon forgot how to respond.

His mouth opened, then closed. He almost hated how effortlessly Mydei could say something like that—something that lodged itself in his chest, settling there like an itch he couldn’t scratch.

Mydei, meanwhile, had already leaned his head back, eyes slipping shut as he exhaled a slow breath. Completely unaware of what he’d just done.

Phainon turned his face slightly, letting the steam veil his expression. “… You talk too much, Your Highness.”

Mydei retorted without even opening his eyes. “And yet, you’re still listening.”

Phainon clicked his tongue but said nothing.

The water rippled between them, the silence stretching—not uncomfortable, but weighted, as if something had shifted.

And Phainon hated to admit it, but his heart was beating just a little too fast.

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The rain fell in steady sheets, pattering against the rooftops of Kremnos like an unending rhythm. It wasn’t a storm, not quite, but it was heavy enough to clear the streets below, the usual market crowds thinning as people hurried for cover.

Phainon had been passing through, minding his own business, when he noticed the lone figure standing at the edge of a high rooftop.

Mydei.

He wasn’t huddled against the cold, nor was he in any rush to seek shelter. He simply stood there, watching the city through the downpour, as if he could see something beyond the mist and rain-blurred lights.

Phainon wasn’t sure why he hesitated. He could’ve left. Should’ve left. But instead, he exhaled through his nose, adjusted the paper-wrapped bundle under his arm, and, without a word, stepped onto the rooftop.

The moment he reached Mydei’s side, he flicked open the umbrella he’d just bought and held it over the prince’s head.

For a moment, there was only silence.

Then—

Mydei blinked, glancing up at the dark fabric shielding him from the rain. His pale hair was already damp, water dripping from the edges, but he made no move to step away. Instead, he looked at Phainon with a quiet sort of curiosity.

“You had no reason to do that,” he said eventually, his voice calm, as if making an observation rather than expressing gratitude.

Phainon shrugged. “Didn’t feel like watching you get drenched.”

Mydei hummed, tilting his gaze back toward the city. “I don’t mind it.”

“Doesn’t mean it’s good for you.”

Mydei exhaled, a soft, almost amused sound. “You speak as though you’re concerned for my well-being.”

Phainon didn’t answer that.

The rain softened slightly, drumming against the umbrella in a steady rhythm. Neither of them spoke for a long moment, standing side by side, half-shadowed by the muted glow of lanterns below.

Then, just as Phainon was about to break the silence, Mydei spoke—almost absentmindedly.

“You stand closer than necessary.”

Phainon stiffened.

It was such a simple statement. Casual, nearly careless. And yet, for some damned reason, it caught him completely off guard.

For a split second, he forgot how to react. His mind supplied too many meanings at once—too many implications, none of which he had any interest in acknowledging.

But Mydei wasn’t even looking at him. His gaze remained on the city, his expression unreadable, as if he hadn’t just said something that sent an odd, unwelcome heat creeping up Phainon’s neck.

Phainon schooled his expression into something flat. “I have no idea what that’s supposed to mean.”

Mydei glanced at him then, eyes steady, before giving the faintest tilt of his head. “Neither do I.”

Phainon clicked his tongue, looking away. “Tch. You talk too much, Your Highness.”

“You’ve said that before.”

“And you still don’t listen.”

Mydei’s lips curved slightly—not quite a smile.

Phainon sighed, shifting the umbrella so it covered them both more evenly. He told himself it was just practicality. Nothing more.

But still, he didn’t move away.

The scent of aged parchment and dust filled the air, thick and heavy with silence. The library was one of the oldest in Castrum Kremnos, tucked away in the deeper corridors of the city, its grand shelves stretching toward the vaulted ceilings. The dim glow of lanterns cast long shadows between the towering stacks, the stillness broken only by the quiet rustle of pages turning in some distant corner.

Phainon moved with purpose, trailing his fingers along the spines of the books without really seeing them. He wasn't here for leisure—he was looking for information, specifically anything that could help him navigate the inner structure of the palace. He'd come across an old text referencing the city's architectural evolution, and if he was lucky, there would be something here detailing the palace's older structures. Hidden passages, weak points in its fortifications.

The last thing he expected was to round a corner and nearly collide with someone already standing there.

A familiar figure stood by one of the grand bookshelves, perched halfway up a ladder, reaching for a thick leather-bound tome. Dark fabric, gold embroidery at the cuffs—Mydei.

Phainon exhaled sharply, half in disbelief, half in sheer frustration. "How the hell do I keep running into you?"

Above him, Mydei stilled, fingers pausing on the spine of the book before he slowly looked down. His gaze met Phainon's, cool yet faintly amused, as though Phainon's words had simply confirmed something he already knew.

"Perhaps it's fate," Mydei mused, his voice carrying that same low, measured cadence. "Or perhaps you just need to choose your hiding spots more wisely."

Phainon crossed his arms, trying not to focus too hard on the absurdity of the situation. This was getting too frequent. Coincidence didn't feel like an excuse anymore.

"You come here often?" he asked dryly.

Mydei pulled the book from the shelf and stepped down from the ladder with the kind of effortless grace Phainon was beginning to associate with him. “Not particularly,” he admitted, flipping through the pages. “But I do enjoy the quiet. And knowledge.” He glanced at Phainon then, eyes sharp despite the idle way he spoke. “You?”

“I like to keep myself informed,” Phainon replied vaguely. He wasn’t about to tell the prince that he was studying ways to break into his home.

Something about the way Mydei held his book—composed, steady—made it seem like he saw right through the half-truth, though he didn’t press. Instead, he idly flipped a page, gaze scanning over the words.

“You don’t strike me as the type to sit still long enough for a book.”

Phainon tilted his head. “You don’t strike me as the type to assume things.”

That earned him the smallest smirk, a flicker of something knowing before Mydei shut the book in his hands. “Touché.”

A strange sort of silence settled between them—not tense, but not exactly comfortable either. A sharp awareness that neither quite belonged in the other’s presence, yet here they were, standing in the dim hush of an ancient library, speaking like old acquaintances.

Too familiar.

Phainon cleared his throat. “Well, Your Highness, much as I enjoy these chance meetings, I’ve got things to do.”

Mydei inclined his head, gaze unreadable. “Try not to get lost, foreigner.”

Phainon watched as Mydei left, waiting until the sound of his footsteps faded before he let out a slow breath. Every time, these encounters were getting more frequent, more personal, and that was a problem. He needed distance, not—whatever this was.

Shaking off the feeling, he pulled out his Telaslate to check his notes. His brows immediately furrowed.

Something was off.

A quick flick of his fingers brought up his contact list, and there, among the few names stored, was a new addition. One that hadn’t been there before.

Phainon stared at the name, then exhaled through his nose, half in disbelief, half in sheer amusement at the sheer irony of the situation.

Mydei.

For a long moment, he just stood there, silent, processing. Then he huffed a quiet laugh, shaking his head as he shut the device.

As he turned to leave, something caught his eye. A book, worn but well-kept, its title embossed in gold: *The Blood of Kings: A Study of the Kremnos Lineage and Their Divine Blessings.*

Phainon hesitated. Then, almost absently, he pulled it from the shelf and flipped it open. The pages were filled with dense text, tracing the history of Castrum Kremnos’ rulers, their military prowess, their conquests. But deeper within the book, he found something else. A passage detailing an old belief—one that claimed certain heirs, on rare occasion, were granted something extraordinary.

Immunity to time.

The wording was careful, dancing around the term immortality, but the implication was clear. A blessing, bestowed by something ancient.

Phainon closed the book, expression unreadable.

He hadn’t thought much of Mydei’s ability to withstand pain, to move like a shadow and strike like something far more trained than a royal should be. But now…

He glanced back toward the library entrance where Mydei had disappeared minutes ago.

“Huh,” he murmured to himself, slipping the book back onto the shelf. “How curious.”

Phainon had spent the last few days weaving through the city, asking the right questions to the right people, never staying too long in one place. Most of what he found was useless—tales passed down like old myths, twisted with time and exaggeration.

But a few stories stood out.

Legends of Kremnos heirs who were different. Not just trained to be warriors, not just rulers shaped by fire and blood, but something more.

Something *inhuman*.

The details were inconsistent. Some said it was a divine gift, others a curse. Some claimed it was nothing but superstition. But the fact that the rumors existed at all meant something.

And Phainon wasn’t in the business of ignoring inconvenient possibilities.

He leaned against the wooden railing of his rented room, staring at the glow of his Telaslate in the dim light. He shouldn’t do this. It was a bad idea.

And yet, before he could talk himself out of it, he tapped the name.

The call rang once. Twice.

Then, a smooth, familiar voice. “Didn’t expect to hear from you so soon.”

Phainon exhaled slowly, keeping his tone casual. “Didn’t plan on it.”

A low hum. “And yet, here you are.”

He ignored the comment. “I had a thought, and you seem like someone who knows his history.”

There was a brief pause before Mydei responded, sounding faintly amused. “You want a history lesson?”

“Something like that.” Phainon glanced toward the window, watching the flicker of torchlights in the streets below. “Kremnos has a reputation. Strength. Endurance. A bloodline built for war. Some say that’s not all it’s built for.”

Mydei didn’t answer right away.

Phainon could almost picture the way he’d tilt his head slightly, considering.

“You’ve been listening to stories,” Mydei finally said, tone unreadable. “Castrum Kremnos does not deal in fairy tales.”

Phainon huffed a quiet laugh. “Most fairy tales start with a grain of truth.”

“Perhaps.” A pause. Then, almost idly, “And what truth are you hoping to find, Snowy?”

Phainon didn’t respond. He wasn’t about to tell Mydei he was looking for weaknesses.

Another quiet hum. “Careful, foreigner. Some answers aren’t meant for wandering ears.”

“I’m just curious.”

“Curiosity can be dangerous.”

Phainon smirked faintly. “Good thing I don’t scare easy.”

A soft chuckle. Not mocking, not condescending—just amused.

There was a shift, the sound of fabric moving, and then Mydei’s voice again, smooth and deliberate. “You ask interesting questions, Phainon.”

And then the line went dead.

Phainon blinked.

Then, suddenly, *finally—*

Oh, *for fuck's sake.*

His grip tightened slightly around the device as the realization settled in.

Not Snowy. Not foreigner. His name.

Of course. *Of course* Mydei had gone through his damn Telaslate.

Phainon let his head fall back against the railing, sighing through his nose. His ears felt warm, but he refused to acknowledge it.

This was getting way too complicated.

Phainon sat at the edge of a desk, arms crossed, expression unreadable. Across from him, Aglaea watched, waiting with that patient, unshakable calm of hers.

"I give up," Phainon said flatly.

A single brow lifted. "Oh?"

"Yeah." He exhaled sharply, shaking his head. "I give up."

Aglaea did not immediately respond, which was somehow worse than if she had. Instead, she simply took a slow sip of her wine, eyes steady on him, as if waiting for him to elaborate.

When he didn't, she set her glass down with deliberate grace. "Well," she said, voice smooth as ever, "that *is* an unexpected development."

Phainon scrubbed a hand down his face, tilting his head back toward the ceiling. "I am so tired, Aglaea."

"How tragic."

“Unbelievably tragic.”

She folded her hands in her lap. “Would you like to explain what, exactly, you are giving up on?”

Phainon let out a humorless laugh. “The assassination. The job. *Him*.” He leaned forward slightly, meeting her gaze. “I give up.”

Aglaea hummed thoughtfully. “And why is that?”

“Because he’s a problem.” Phainon gestured vaguely, as if that somehow explained everything. “He keeps showing up. Everywhere. And the more I talk to him, the worse this gets.”

A brief pause. Then—

“Ah,” Aglaea said lightly, as if it all made sense now.

Phainon narrowed his eyes. “*Ah*? What does that mean?”

She took another sip of wine. “Nothing at all.”

“Liar.”

Aglaea’s lips curved into the faintest hint of amusement. “So. You refuse to complete the contract?”

“I refuse to deal with *him*.”

“How noble of you.”

Phainon clicked his tongue. “It’s not about that.”

“Of course not.”

He gave her a flat look.

Aglaea, as always, was unbothered. She leaned back slightly, studying him in that way that made him feel like she was *peeling him apart*, layer by

layer. “And what,” she asked, tone perfectly even, “do you plan to do now?”

Phainon exhaled. “I don’t know.”

“Mm.” A soft sound of consideration. Then, smoothly, she said, “Liar.”

Phainon groaned, dragging a hand down his face. “Aglaea.”

“Yes?”

“I hate you.”

“How unfortunate.”

Phainon let his head drop against the desk with a dull *thud*.

Aglaea just sipped her wine.

Phainon stood in the center of Aglaea’s study, arms outstretched as she meticulously adjusted the folds of the dark fabric draped over his shoulders. He looked less than amused.

“This is unnecessary,” he muttered.

“On the contrary,” Aglaea replied smoothly, stepping back to examine her work. “This is entirely necessary.”

Phainon sighed, shifting slightly as she tugged at the fit of his sleeves. “You know I could’ve handled this myself.”

Aglaea gave him a sharp look. “You and I both know that is a lie.”

He scowled. “My outfits aren’t that bad.”

A delicate snort. “Ocher-yellow shirt and dromas-purple pants.”

“That was one time.”

“One deeply unfortunate time.”

Phainon clicked his tongue, looking away. “Didn’t realize I was under a fashion tribunal.”

“You weren’t. If you were, you’d have been sentenced already.” She stepped closer, a glint of mischief in her eyes.

He gave her a flat look, but Aglaea was unfazed as she picked up the embroidered mask from the desk beside her, pressing it into his hands. “Regardless, this is a formal event, not one of your usual shadowed excursions. You must look the part.”

Phainon turned the mask over in his hands, fingers brushing the smooth edges. A red, accented with silver—a subtle nod to Kremnos’ royal colors, though not overtly so.

“Subtle,” he admitted, grudgingly impressed.

“Obviously.”

Phainon exhaled sharply, rolling his shoulders. “You really didn’t have to go this far.”

“Would you rather I leave you to your own devices? Let you waltz in wearing something atrocious?”

“I would’ve picked something decent.”

Aglaea’s expression was doubtful at best. “I am not in the habit of taking chances with the impossible.”

Phainon groaned, rubbing his temple. “You enjoy this, don’t you?”

Her lips curled ever so slightly. “Immensely.”

Phainon shook his head, slipping the mask into his coat. His fingers lingered against the fabric, anxiety and anticipation swirling within him.

Tomorrow.

He would see Mydei again.

And this time, it wouldn’t just be an unexpected encounter.

This time, it would be intentional.

Phainon stood outside the carriage, his mask in hand, staring at the imposing silhouette of Castrum Kremnos against the night sky. The palace loomed like a fortress, its spires piercing the darkness, and the sounds of laughter and music drifted through the air, mingling with the sharp scent of night-blooming jasmine.

He climbed into the carriage, the leather seat cool beneath him. As the door shut with a soft click, he took a deep breath, feeling the familiar weight of anticipation settle in his chest. He wasn’t nervous; after all, he had faced countless high-stakes missions before. Yet tonight, a gnawing sense of unease lingered in the pit of his stomach, an unsettling feeling that had nothing to do with fear and everything to do with the stakes involved.

He pulled the mask over his face, adjusting it to ensure it sat comfortably. The red fabric framed his eyes, and he could feel its presence as a reminder of the role he was about to play. It was a façade, a layer between him and the world, and he needed to stay sharp.

As the carriage rumbled through the streets, he focused on the rhythm of the wheels against the cobblestones, using it to steady his thoughts. He mentally reviewed the plan—observe, gather information, and then execute the contract. Simple enough.

When the carriage finally halted, he took a moment to collect himself. The palace entrance loomed ahead, flanked by guards in imposing armor. He opened the door, stepping out into the night, and locked his gaze onto the grand doors ahead.

Each step towards the entrance felt deliberate as he readied himself for what lay ahead. He could already hear the chatter of guests inside, their voices mingling with the music that floated through the air. Phainon drew in a steadying breath, squared his shoulders, and prepared to enter the whirlwind of deception and intrigue that awaited him. This wasn't just another assignment; it was a chance to uncover secrets and navigate the complexities of the royal court. And as he stepped forward, he was determined to meet the challenge head-on.

Phainon drew in a steadying breath, squared his shoulders, and prepared to enter the whirlwind of deception that awaited him. This wasn't just another assignment; it was a chance to observe, but also to finish the job. He steeled himself, ready to navigate the chaos inside the palace. No matter what happened next, he knew he had to keep his wits about him.

Phainon stepped cautiously into the grand hall, the atmosphere alive with the hum of conversation and the soft cadence of music weaving through the air. Flickering candlelight danced against the high ceilings, casting an ethereal glow that cloaked the attendees in shadows and intrigue. Masked figures swirled about, their identities concealed, their laughter mingling with the melody—a gathering of secrets and whispers.

His pulse quickened as he surveyed the room, each face hidden behind elaborate masks, a sea of mystery and potential danger. And then he spotted him.

Mydei.

The Crown Prince stood near the edge of the floor, his posture relaxed yet alert, the elegance of his movements captivating even from a distance. Phainon felt a pull toward him, an instinctive urge to close the distance despite the weight of his mission pressing down on him.

He took a moment to gather himself, observing Mydei as he engaged with the guests around him. The prince's laughter rang out, a sound both charming and disarming, as he interacted with those who dared to approach. There was an air of confidence about him, an assurance that spoke to the

power he held. Phainon felt an unexpected thrill at the prospect of approaching him, despite the complexities that loomed between them.

As he moved forward, weaving through the throng of masked guests, a small part of him hesitated. How can he explain he managed to secure an invitation to such a prestigious event? The Crown Prince's presence here was both an opportunity and a risk, but Phainon couldn't help but feel a magnetic pull.

When he finally reached Mydei, the prince's gaze flickered up, surprise flashing across his features for a brief moment before it was replaced by a more neutral mask. "You? Here?" Mydei said, his voice low, almost teasing, a hint of amusement dancing in his tone.

Phainon offered a casual smile, relishing the moment. "I have my ways. Care for a dance, Your Highness?" He extended his hand, the invitation hanging in the air between them, charged with unspoken possibilities.

Mydei studied him for a heartbeat, a flicker of curiosity in his eyes. "You do realize this is a royal ball? How did you get in?"

Phainon shrugged, keeping his tone light. "Does it matter? I'm here now."

After a brief pause, Mydei's lips curved into a smirk, and he placed his hand in Phainon's, an agreement without further words. "Well, then. Why not?"

With that, the dance began, their movements fluid as they glided across the floor, the world around them fading into the background. The music swelled, enveloping them in a cocoon of sound, the space between them electric.

Phainon couldn't help but be captivated by Mydei's presence—the way he moved, the way his eyes sparkled behind the mask, a combination of confidence and something else he couldn't quite place. The masks they wore added a layer of anonymity, allowing them to explore this moment without the burdens of their identities weighing them down.

As they danced, the tension between them grew palpable, a blend of curiosity and a connection that seemed to defy the circumstances. Phainon leaned in slightly, keeping his voice low as he spoke. “You move well for a prince.”

Mydei’s expression remained playful, a glimmer of mischief in his eyes. “And you for a foreigner. I must admit, I didn’t expect this.”

“Neither did I,” Phainon replied, an edge of sincerity creeping into his voice. “But here we are.”

The music enveloped them, and for a fleeting moment, it felt as though nothing else mattered. The shadows of the hall danced around them, a cloak of anonymity that allowed them to explore the thrill of the moment without the weight of their realities crashing down.

As the dance continued, Phainon found himself wanting to lean closer, to decipher the man behind the mask. But he reminded himself of the stakes, the job he was meant to finish. Still, Mydei was an enigma, and this moment felt like a chance to learn more about him, even as the specter of their fates loomed overhead.

“Tell me, what is it like being a prince?” Phainon asked, his curiosity getting the better of him.

Mydei regarded him with a thoughtful expression, as if weighing his words carefully. “It’s not all it’s built up to be,” he said, his voice laced with an unexpected sincerity. “There are many eyes on me, many expectations. It can be… stifling at times.”

Phainon nodded, understanding more than he let on. “I can imagine.”

As the music quickened, the atmosphere shifted, the pace urging them closer together. Phainon felt Mydei lean in slightly, their bodies aligning as they moved in sync. It was a subtle shift, but the thrill of being this close to the Crown Prince ignited something within him.

For the first time, Mydei spoke his name, his tone almost bored, as if it was just another fact in a long list. “Phainon.”

Phainon’s grip on Mydei’s waist instinctively tightened, though he forced himself to remain composed. He didn’t respond, opting instead to focus on the rhythm, but inside, he felt a rush at hearing his name come from the prince’s lips.

“Do you know,” Mydei began casually, his voice barely above the music, “that assassins often blend in seamlessly with their surroundings? It’s fascinating, really.”

The words hit Phainon like a splash of cold water. He froze for a split second, his mind racing as he processed what Mydei had just said. His thoughts spiraled—did the prince know? Had he figured it out?

Before he could pull back or even think to respond, Mydei took the lead in their dance, guiding him effortlessly across the floor. Phainon stumbled slightly, caught off guard by the sudden shift in control. “Wait—what?” he managed to mutter, the panic barely masked beneath the music and laughter around them.

“Just keep up, Phainon,” Mydei said, his voice laced with an intriguing nonchalance. “I promise I won’t let you fall.”

Phainon’s heart raced—not just from the dance but from the precarious situation he found himself in. Here he was, caught in a swirl of silk and shadow, the prince unaware of the true nature of their encounter. He debated making a break for it, but the thought seemed absurd; he was vulnerable, right in the heart of the kingdom, and the last thing he needed was to draw attention to himself.

As they danced, Phainon’s mind raced, trying to read Mydei’s expression. The prince remained effortlessly graceful, moving with a confidence that almost disarmed him. Every twirl and shift in the music only drew him deeper into this unexpected moment, the space between them filled with unspoken tension and curiosity.

“Interesting, isn’t it?” Mydei continued, seemingly oblivious to Phainon’s internal struggle. “How easily one can dance around the truth, even in plain sight.”

Phainon’s breath caught, and he found himself weighing his options carefully. The urge to pull away warred with the desire to stay, to find out just how much Mydei truly knew. Instead, he focused on the music, letting it guide them as he silently questioned how he could have let himself get this close, both physically and metaphorically.

The room swirled around them, masked figures spinning in and out of view, but all Phainon could see was Mydei—the way he moved, the way he spoke, the way the dance turned them into two figures lost in a world of their own making.

Phainon took a steadying breath, forcing himself to feign calmness amidst the tension that crackled between them. “Let’s change the subject,” he said, his voice even, but the slight quiver betrayed his unease.

Mydei’s lips curled into a faint smirk, a glint of amusement in his eyes. “I like this subject, though,” he replied smoothly, as if the prospect of discussing assassins was the most intriguing topic in the world.

Phainon felt the heat rise in his cheeks despite himself. Mydei effortlessly guided him in the dance, their bodies moving fluidly in sync as he led with an almost predatory grace. Phainon tried to regain his composure, but Mydei’s playful confidence only intensified the fire building between them.

“Do you find it fascinating?” Mydei continued, leaning in just a fraction closer. “The way someone can hide in plain sight, blending into the chaos, observing everything without anyone ever knowing?” His voice dropped to a conspiratorial whisper, as if sharing a secret that was just for Phainon.

Phainon swallowed hard, his heart racing. “It’s a skill, for sure,” he managed, attempting to steer the conversation elsewhere, but the way Mydei held him so close made it difficult to think. “But let’s not—”

“Why not?” Mydei interrupted, a teasing lilt to his tone. “It’s not every day you get to dance with an assassin, is it?”

The heat between them grew more intense as Mydei’s fingers trailed along Phainon’s waist, guiding him with a firmness that left little room for resistance. Phainon felt a rush of adrenaline as they spun and twirled, caught in the rhythm of the music and the charged atmosphere surrounding them.

As the tempo increased, so did the closeness of their bodies. Phainon’s breath quickened, and he felt Mydei’s forehead brush against his, their faces inches apart. The world around them faded away, leaving only the two of them in their own bubble of swirling colors and muted sounds.

“Let’s take this somewhere else,” Mydei murmured, his voice low and inviting, sending a shiver down Phainon’s spine.

Phainon’s heart raced, caught between the thrill of the moment and the weight of his reality. The offer hung in the air between them, tempting and dangerous. He was an assassin, a predator in a world of shadows, but here, with Mydei, everything felt different—intense, electrifying, and utterly unpredictable.

“Are you sure that’s a good idea?” Phainon asked, his voice barely above a whisper, yet he could feel the undeniable pull drawing him closer.

Mydei’s gaze held a mix of challenge and allure. “Good ideas aren’t my thing,” he replied, the hint of a smile playing on his lips. “Come on, Phainon. Let’s see where this takes us.”

And just like that, with his heart pounding and the weight of his mission lurking in the back of his mind, Phainon found himself unable to resist.

As the music faded into the distance, Mydei led Phainon through a narrow corridor, the palace’s opulence giving way to the shadows of the hidden corners. Phainon’s heart raced, a mixture of excitement and apprehension thrumming beneath his skin. This was dangerous territory, and yet, there

was something intoxicating about the way Mydei moved—confident, assured, and utterly captivating.

They stepped into a dimly lit alcove, the air thick with tension as Mydei turned to face him, an intensity in his gaze that sent a shiver down Phainon's spine. The moment stretched, thick with anticipation, before Mydei closed the distance between them. Phainon felt the wall press against his back, and before he could gather his thoughts, Mydei was pinning him there, one hand on his shoulder, the other brushing against the nape of his neck.

Phainon's breath hitched, his body reacting to the heat radiating from Mydei. "What are you doing?" he managed to ask, though the question felt futile as Mydei leaned in closer, their lips mere inches apart.

"Something I've wanted to do since we first met," Mydei murmured, his voice low and seductive. The world around them faded as Mydei closed the gap, capturing Phainon's lips in a searing kiss that sent fire coursing through his veins.

Phainon's mind whirled—this was reckless, thrilling, and utterly wrong. He responded instinctively, his hands finding their way to Mydei's waist, pulling him closer as their bodies melded together. The kiss deepened, a frantic dance of tongues and breaths as they lost themselves in the moment.

But as their passion escalated, Phainon's other hand slipped beneath his cloak, fingers brushing against the cool steel of his knife. The reality of his mission crashed down upon him like a wave. He was here to kill the prince. To betray the very person he now craved.

"Phainon," Mydei whispered, pulling back just enough to meet his gaze, a knowing look in his eyes. "You know what you have to do."

The weight of those words hung heavy in the air, and Phainon felt a visceral chill race down his spine. "I can't—" he began, but Mydei's gaze was unyielding, almost inviting.

“Do it,” Mydei urged, voice steady and calm, as if they were discussing the weather instead of a life-or-death decision. “If you’re going to kill me, just get it over with.”

In a moment of madness, spurred by the intoxicating mix of desire and desperation, Phainon brought the knife to Mydei’s chest. His heart pounded in his ears as he pressed the blade against the fabric of Mydei’s shirt.

Mydei’s breath hitched, but he didn’t flinch. Instead, he leaned closer, guiding the knife with a gentle pressure. “You know what you have to do, Phainon. It’s what you’re good at.”

As the blade sank into flesh, a chilling realization washed over Phainon. The warmth of blood seeped between his fingers, the visceral weight of betrayal settling heavily in his gut. “No, no, no,” he gasped, disbelief igniting a wild panic within him. His heart raced, pounding against his chest like a caged animal desperate to escape.

He stumbled back, horror gripping him. *What have I done?* Thoughts spiraled out of control as he knelt beside Mydei, the lifeless body crumpled at his feet. Each breath felt like a leaden weight, his mind wrestling with the irrevocable choice he had made. The gravity of the moment twisted in his chest, an ache that felt insurmountable.

For a brief instant, the room was silent, the aftermath of his actions echoing in the stillness. Then, without warning, Mydei’s eyes fluttered open. Phainon’s breath caught in his throat, disbelief washing over him as the prince inhaled deeply, as if awakening from a deep slumber.

“Honestly, you should really be more careful with your blade,” Mydei remarked, a casual tone underscoring the absurdity of the situation. He pushed himself upright, brushing off the remnants of blood with a dispassionate air.

“What… How?” Phainon stammered, staring in disbelief. He had just stabbed the prince—hadn’t he?

“Oh, I don’t know,” Mydei replied, tilting his head as he regarded Phainon with a mix of curiosity and amusement. “Something about being immortal, perhaps?”

Phainon blinked, the reality of his situation slowly sinking in. Mydei’s cool demeanor was unsettling, a stark contrast to the panic swirling in Phainon’s chest.

“Are you… serious?” Phainon managed to ask, struggling to comprehend the surreal turn of events.

“Deadly so,” Mydei quipped, a faint smile playing at the corners of his lips. He leaned back, stretching slightly as if shaking off the remnants of sleep. “But that’s hardly the point, is it?”

Phainon swallowed hard, trying to regain his composure. “I just… completed my contract,” he said, his voice barely above a whisper. He has technically killed the prince.

“Congratulations,” Mydei replied, an eyebrow arching in mock approval. “But you might want to consider your next move very carefully. After all, you’re at my mercy right now.”

A chill ran down Phainon’s spine at the implication. Here was Mydei, the prince of Kremnos, seemingly unscathed and now very much in control of the situation. The tension in the air shifted, and Phainon felt the weight of his vulnerability in that moment.

“Do you enjoy this?” Phainon asked, irritation threading through his disbelief. “Toying with me like this?”

Mydei regarded him coolly, the relishing look never leaving his eyes. “It’s simply a matter of perspective. You seem to have a talent for making things interesting, Phainon.”

The mention of his name hung in the air, a reminder of how little power he truly wielded now. Phainon hesitated, feeling the precariousness of the

moment envelop him. The stakes had changed in a heartbeat, and he was left grappling with the unexpected consequences of his actions.

Phainon took a deep breath, forcing himself to steady his racing heart. He clenched his jaw, ready to bolt if necessary. “What do you want?” he asked through gritted teeth, forcing himself to bend down slightly, preparing for whatever was coming next.

Mydei paused for a moment, an unexpected glint of uncertainty in his eyes. “I’d like to take you on a date. A proper one,” he said, his tone casual, but there was a hint of vulnerability beneath the surface.

Phainon froze, stunned by the request. A date? With Mydei? It felt almost absurd, especially considering the circumstances. But as he studied the prince’s expression, he noticed the subtle tension in his posture, the way he fidgeted slightly, a contrast to the usual charismatic air he exuded. There was something adorably nervous about it, and despite the complications swirling in Phainon’s mind, he found himself wanting to say yes.

“But the contract…” he began, struggling to reconcile the two realities. He had just attempted to kill the prince, and now they were discussing dinner? “I mean, technically, I completed it by… well, you’re still alive.”

“Technicalities,” Mydei replied dismissively, waving a hand as if brushing the matter aside. “Let’s call it a post-assassination dinner. A celebration of my… revival.”

Phainon felt the weight of his situation crash down on him. He had seen too much, experienced too much, and yet the idea of spending time with Mydei —however complicated—was strangely appealing.

Before he could fully respond, Phainon’s Telaslate chimed, breaking through the tension. He glanced down, recognizing Aglaea’s name flashing on the screen. With a mix of dread and curiosity, he opened the message.

Everything has been taken care of.

Phainon felt his heart drop for a moment before a pause lingered, and the last line of her message caught him off guard.

?

He groaned softly, feeling the awkwardness rise in his chest as he attempted to reject Mydei, still half-dazed from the chaos of their recent encounter. “Listen, about the date…”

“Is that a yes or a no?” Mydei interjected, a hint of disappointment in his tone.

“It’s… complicated,” Phainon stammered, his mind racing as he tried to navigate his feelings.

Mydei’s brow furrowed slightly, his expression shifting to something more serious, but just as the weight of the moment threatened to become too heavy, Phainon glanced back at his Telaslate.

“Honestly, I—” he started, but Mydei cut him off again.

“I get it, you’re not interested,” he said, the light in his gaze dimming slightly, but before he could pull away, Phainon’s finger hovered over the screen.

Then, with a sigh, he said, “Why the hell not.”

The tension eased slightly as Mydei arched an eyebrow, a smile tugging at his lips, but the playfulness felt muted. “Just remember not to stab me again, or this date is over.”

Phainon couldn’t help but chuckle, shaking his head. “Noted. But you might want to keep your distance, just in case.”

Mydei rolled his eyes, but there was a hint of warmth in his expression as he spoke sarcastically. “Great, a date filled with paranoia. What more could I ask for?”

Phainon sighed dramatically. “At least we’ll have something to talk about. Just promise you won’t mention my fashion choices, and we’ll be fine.”

“Deal. And you know what? I’ll try not to bring up your previous attempts on my life either.”

With that, they shared a laugh, the tension dissipating, and the absurdity of their situation finally sank in. It was a bizarre turn of events, but Phainon couldn’t shake the feeling that this date might just be the strangest, yet most intriguing, adventure yet.

End Notes

Again, sorry abt posting late but this is probably gonna be my last single post till 3.1 comes (Unless i’m hit with like a bomb of inspiration😭 Scratch that I might write one more during the weekends) so I’m probably gonna focus on finishing and adding some extra chapters to my ongoing and completed fics😙

Writing isn’t the issue with me, I already do that like everyday, but god I never have enough TIMMEEE, i think this is actually the longest I’ve gone without writing sm actually-

Whatever, hope u guys enjoyed!!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!